

03/06/26

Free Talk

Defense / defence 答辯

Insurance 保險

Healthcare system 医疗系统

Emergency department (ED) 急诊

Homework Analysis

Article

逻辑: packed schedule → less free time → free time is important →
(lack of free time → stress and negative development)?

Forcing Children to Develop Talents Can Be Harmful

Nowadays, many parents focus ^{heavily} strongly on developing their children's talents. Some people believe that special skills can help children succeed in the future. However, others argue that too much training ^{Good!} may harm children's well-being. In my opinion, forcing children to develop talents ^{may/could} can be harmful.

Firstly, intensive training may cause pressure and reduce ^{children's} free time. When children have a ^{packed} heavy schedule filled with extra classes and practice sessions, they have less time to play and relax.

However, free time is essential for healthy growth because it allows children to rest and socialize with friends. ^{...① attend tuition? ← ?} For example, if children attend tuition every day after school, they may not have enough opportunities to interact with ^{their} peers. As a result, they may develop weaker social skills and feel unhappy due to constant stress and exhaustion.

Secondly, forcing children to learn skills they dislike may also cause mental ^{health} problems. When children are required to do something they do not enjoy, they often lose motivation and feel frustrated. Over time, this frustration can turn into negative emotions such as anxiety or low self-esteem. For instance, a child who is forced to learn an instrument ^{despite having no interest in it} without interest may feel stressed before every lesson. Consequently, this ongoing pressure may even damage the parent-child relationship.

In conclusion, although developing talents may seem beneficial, intensive training and forcing children to learn what they dislike can lead to pressure and mental health problems. Therefore, parents should respect their children's interests and allow them to grow happily.

Title

Excellent!!

Introduction

Nowadays, many parents focus strongly on developing their children's talents.

Nowadays, many parents focus **heavily** on developing their children's talents.

Some other more natural expressions:

- ① focus heavily on
- ② place great emphasis on

In my opinion, forcing children to develop talents **can** be harmful.

can 的语气比 may / could 更加坚定

学术写作还是保守一点，用“hedging”

In my opinion, forcing children to develop talents **may / could** be harmful.

Body Paragraph 1

Firstly, intensive training may cause pressure and reduce free time.

reduce 谁的 free time?

虽然从上下文能知道，Forrest 指的是“孩子”，但句子本身没有明确说出来这是 vague reference（指代模糊）

When children have a **heavy** schedule filled with extra classes and practice sessions, ...

Firstly, intensive training may cause pressure and reduce **children's** free time.

When children have a **packed** schedule filled with extra classes and practice sessions, ...

① 搭配习惯（collocation）

“时间表被排满”，最常用的表达是：

a **packed** schedule

a **packed** timetable

a **packed** day

② packed 还可以：

*形容空间里人很多

packed room / **packed** stadium / **packed** train

*形容活动内容很多、很丰富

a **packed** program / a **packed** agenda

*形容内容或信息很多（“信息量很大”）

The book is **packed** with useful information.

Free time is essential for healthy growth because it allows children to rest and socialize with friends.

However, free time is essential for healthy growth because it allows children to rest and socialize with friends.

这部分内容逻辑如下：

孩子课很多 → 没有自由时间 → （但自）由时间非常重要

加了“however” → 突出一种对比

在 example 之前，逻辑不完整

example 前加上：

Without enough free time, children may experience stress and fatigue, which can negatively affect their development.

① Forrest 原文逻辑：

Packed schedule → less free time → free time is important

② 更缜密的逻辑：

Packed schedule → less free time → free time is important → **lack of free time → stress and negative development**

*现象

*原因

*如果没有，会出现什么问题

*导致的结果

For example, if children **attend tuition** every day after school, they may not have enough opportunities to interact with peers.

For example, if children **attend extra classes / have tutoring lessons** every day after school, they may not have enough opportunities to interact with peers.

① 能明白 Forrest 想表达什么，但是因为老师没有听过这个说法，查了一下：

attend tuition → 新加坡、马来西亚、香港等地区英语里很常见

② 英式英语或美式英语中，tuition 通常指“**学费**”

*university tuition

*tuition fees

③ 去补习班更常见的表达:

Attend / attend:

private tutoring / tutoring lessons / extra classes

Body Paragraph 2

Secondly, forcing children to learn skills they dislike may also cause mental problems.

Secondly, forcing children to learn skills they dislike may also cause mental health problems.

① mental problems 本身没错，但是

“mental problems” 更偏向 “精神问题” （比较严重的情况）

② “mental health problems” → “心理健康问题” （心理状态或情绪困扰）

*anxiety / low self-esteem / feeling stressed / feeling unhappy...

For instance, a child who is forced to learn an instrument without interest may feel stressed before every lesson.

For instance, a child who is forced to learn an instrument without being interested / despite having no interest in it may feel stressed before every lesson.

更自然的表达（动名词结构）：

without being interested (in it) → without + V-ing

更多例子:

without knowing

without understanding

without realizing

Conclusion

Excellent!

New Writing Task - In-class Practising

1.3. Text C: Visiting the Antarctic

Read **Text C**, and then answer **Questions 2(a)–(d)** and **Question 3** on the question paper

Text C: Visiting the Antarctic

Saffron is 18 and about to leave school for higher education at college. She and her mother are holidaying on a boat in the Antarctic. This text contains her mother's journal entries for this period.

Tuesday

Spent today in bed as our ship rocked over the rough seas. We're both feeling seasick. Saffron is worried about the higher education course she has chosen. She thinks Environmental Science may be a mistake. Apparently, her friend Josie choosing to study Medicine is a bigger deal than I had expected.

Maybe I shouldn't have been so pushy about her choosing Environmental Science but I know she'll just love it like I did years ago.

She's also complaining about my decision to come to these remote islands in this cold (Josie and her family are holidaying in the sun, apparently, with lots of other young people around). The fact that we've had no internet access for days hasn't helped either.

Not the best day.

Thursday

Today we went out in Zodiacs. These are the small inflatable boats that take us from our cruise ship to explore the bays.

I woke this morning to complete and total stillness. Knowing this meant we were in Antarctica, I quickly woke Saffron up and, grabbing our jackets, we hurried up to the deck. Well, I hurried; Saffron seemed less enthusiastic.

John was the expedition leader in charge of our Zodiac, which held eight excited older tourists, Saffron and me.

We all gasped at the heavenly sights. There were panoramic views of glaciers, mountains and icebergs, basking in the sunshine and cutting white lines between the clear blue sky and the silent waters of the bay around us. John took us along the seemingly endless face of glacier. We were captivated by its crevassed and sculpted glory, that is until a lone seal surfaced to distract us, rolling playfully alongside the boat, before disappearing into the secret depths below.

After this, John carefully guided the Zodiac through the sea of white. He explained the different ice formations and how ancient glaciers break into towering icebergs, before floating silently on their lonely journey out to sea.

Watching the broken ice blocks, Saffron asked him how much evidence he had seen of climate change in his time working for the cruise ship.

In response, John's face dropped and he pointed inland to where we could see verdant plant life greedily snatching at gentle contours of quietly receding ice.

'I never saw that when I first led expeditions,' he sighed. 'Our penguins are the main victims. What will happen to them when all their ice is gone?'

Penguins! I am so excited about seeing penguins. Tomorrow hopefully. Saffron seems more cheerful. We didn't talk about college choices today.

Friday

Today was a good day. We went back out in the Zodiac. And we did see penguins!

John asked Saffron about her plans for college. She told him about her Environmental Science course, how she and Josie have been together in school since they were five and had big dreams of working together to make changes in the world. 'Josie's going to be a doctor,' Saffron told him. In reply, John explained how his work here took him away from family and friends for long periods and how much he looked forward to holidays with them. 'That's an interesting course you've chosen, though,' he added. 'It's crucial that accurate information about places like Antarctica is shared and influences our actions as human beings.'

Saffron seemed thoughtful. She even started asking me questions about my time studying Environmental Science and, incredibly, she listened to my answers.

But the penguins! We visited an enormous colony of them. They were comically squabbling over a perfect pebble – yes, a pebble! – that several wanted to poach from a neighbour's nest. Next minute, they forgot their petty domestic warring to unite angrily in noisy chastising of an opportunistic predatory gull which had its beady eye on an unprotected egg. I laughed and laughed and was delighted to see a huge grin on Saffron's face too.

Sad to be leaving tomorrow.

Question 3

You are Saffron. After your trip to Antarctica you write a letter to your friend Josie.

In your letter you should:

- describe what you saw and did on the trip **and** how it made you feel
- give your thoughts about the people you spent time with on the trip
- explain how this trip has influenced you **and** your thoughts about what you might like to do in the future.

Write the words of the letter.

Base your letter on what you have read in **Text C**, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullets.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

Questions for Forrest:

Who are “you”? → **Saffron**

Who are you writing to? → **Josie**

用第几人称? → **第一人称 (I / my / we)**

写作语气? → **信件语气 (Dear..., Best wishes...)**

! TRY TO USE YOUR OWN WORDS !

What can we know from from Text C:

	Information from the text	Possible ideas
What you saw/did	Zodiac boats, glaciers, icebergs, seal, penguins	amazing, exciting
People	Mum, John	knowledgeable, caring
Future influence	climate change, Environmental Science	maybe study it

4 Paragraph

Paragraph 1: Opening → Trip start

① greeting

Dear Josie,

I've just returned from Antarctica and I can't wait to tell you about the trip.

② mention the trip

At the beginning, it was not very pleasant, because the sea ~~rocked~~ (→ was rough), and we both felt seasick. However, things changed and we felt better when we were on Zodiac boats.

Paragraph 2: Experiences → What I saw and did

① what you saw / what you did

We went on an inflatable boat called Zodiac to explore the icy bays. The

scenery was breathtaking, with huge glaciers, towering icebergs and snow-covered mountains under a bright blue sky with the sun shining. Everything around us was quiet and the water was peaceful/calm. One of the most **memorable** moments ~~happened~~ (→ was) when a ~~lone~~ seal suddenly appeared beside our boat, and played happily in the water before diving back into the deep water. The penguins were extremely **amusing** to watch. Some of them were arguing noisily over small pebbles for their nests, while others gathered together to chase away a gull that was trying to steal an egg.

② how you felt

/ (已经融合在上面的内容了)

Paragraph 3: People → People I met

① John

② Mum

③ what you thought about them

Paragraph 4: Influence / future → What I learned / my future

① climate change

② Environmental Science

③ future ideas

Homework 1 - LETTER

完成 P7 ~ 10 的 Letter

Homework 2 - ARTICLE

Exercise 6

14 In class, you discussed whether schools should teach students about environmental protection.

Here are some comments from your classmates:

Students should learn how to protect the environment from a young age.

Environmental protection should be taught by parents, not schools.

Learning about the environment can help us build a better future.

Schools already have too many subjects.

Write an article for your school magazine, giving your views.

The comments above may give you some ideas, and you can also use some ideas of your own.

Your article should be between 100 and 150 words long.

You will receive up to 6 marks for the content of your article, and up to 6 marks for the language used.